



Mostly sunny 81/58 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 80/49 B20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, MARCH 10, 2026 • \$4

## Push to fill federal jobs is on after cuts

Trump administration reverses Musk-led purge that slashed workforce

BY EMILY DAVIES  
AND MERYL KORNFELD

A year after Elon Musk and his Department of Government Efficiency allies purged hundreds of thousands of federal employees, the Trump administration is ramping up hiring — a reversal that reflects a quiet retreat from one of the president's defining early priorities and marks a new phase in efforts to reshape the bureaucracy in his image.

"We probably have some skills that we now need to hire back, quite frankly," Scott Kupor, the head of the Office of Personnel Management, said in an interview with The Washington Post. "There's no question anytime you do restructurings ... sometimes you over-restructure, sometimes you under-restructure."

The hiring push is unfolding under new rules designed to give the White House greater influence over the government's 2-million person civilian workforce. The administration has lifted restrictions imposed during last year's reductions and created job classifications that make it easier to hire — and fire — employees aligned with the president's priorities. Kupor, who was sworn in last July, said the administration hopes to rebuild in part by rebranding the government as a launchpad for college graduates and early-career professionals and by focusing on recruitment for health care, program management and technology roles.

In recent months, the administration has moved to centralize hiring decisions, expand the role of political appointees in recruitment and roll back diversity initiatives adopted under previous administrations. Together, the shifts amount to changes supporters say will make government more responsive to elected leadership. But critics warn they could erode long-standing protections meant to keep the civil

SEE TRUMP ON A16

### Iran



MAJID SAEEDI/GETTY IMAGES

**Demonstrators gather with Iranian national flags for a rally in support of Mojtaba Khamenei, the country's new supreme leader.**

### Israel



ALEX J. ROSENFELD/GETTY IMAGES

**First responders load a body into a truck after at least two people in Yehud were killed by shrapnel from an Iranian projectile.**

### Lebanon



HASSAN AMMAR/AP

**Families displaced by Israeli airstrikes in Beirut's southern suburbs sit inside a school that has been converted into a shelter.**

### Cyprus



GONZALO FUENTES/REUTERS

**French President Emmanuel Macron visits the French aircraft carrier Charles de Gaulle on a trip to discuss European security.**

## Trump defines wartime presidency with his unique political style

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

MIAMI — A little more than a week into the fight with Iran, President Donald Trump is recasting the role of wartime leader in his image, breaking from generations of practice as he attacks domestic enemies, jumps on issues as far afield as alleged voter fraud and college sports, and revels in meme-driven celebrations of America's military prowess.

Trump's approach to leading the nation in war is in keeping with his precedent-smashing style of politics. His supporters say that style has enabled him to connect with Americans and build a passionate bond with his political base in a way his oppo-

nents have not.

But his lack of a visible effort to try to expand the basis of support for the war carries risks. That's especially true as the U.S. death toll mounts, gasoline prices shoot upward and other issues Americans care about, such as the economy, take a back seat to what Trump says is an attempt to fix a problem that no American president since the Iranian Revolution in 1979 has dared to solve.

Trump has devoted much of his time over the past week to meetings with top national security advisers and managing the war. But he has also found space to post on Truth Social eight times about a dispute with

SEE PRESIDENCY ON A6

## First wave of Iran strikes cost \$5.6 billion, Pentagon says

BY NOAH ROBERTSON

The Pentagon burned through \$5.6 billion worth of munitions during the first two days of its military assault on Iran, according to three U.S. officials, a figure that underscores the deepening alarm among some on Capitol Hill over the speed at which U.S. forces have eaten into the scarce supply of America's most advanced weaponry.

The estimate, shared with Congress on Monday, raises new questions about the Trump administration's broad dismissal of lawmakers' concerns that the Iran operation is quickly eroding the U.S. military's readiness.

The Trump administration also is expected to send Congress

a supplemental defense budget request as soon as this week — potentially totaling tens of billions of dollars — to help sustain its campaign, officials said. That, too, is expected to face opposition from many Democrats whose attempts to restrain the administration from further military action in Iran have come up empty.

In response to questions from the state of U.S. weapons inventories, Sean Parnell, the Pentagon's chief spokesman, issued a statement saying that the Defense Department has "everything it needs to execute any mission at the time and place of the President's choosing and on any timeline."

It's unclear how long the war

SEE WAR COST ON A9

## Prices for oil spike, plunge

G-7 LEADERS KEEP RESERVES UNTAPPED

Markets close up despite uncertainties about Iran

BY EVAN HALPER  
AND TODD C. FRANKEL

Oil prices reached heights not seen since the aftermath of Russia's 2022 invasion of Ukraine on Monday before falling back by the time markets closed, as the Trump administration sent mixed signals about its Iran plans.

The price for a barrel of Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, had at one point spiked to nearly \$120, a level that could translate into gas prices surpassing a national average of \$4 per gallon. But prices turned by midday, dropping precipitously to settle at under \$90 per barrel, a level still significantly higher than before the United States and Israel began strikes on Iran just over a week ago.

President Donald Trump fed the volatility when he posted on social media over the weekend that soaring oil prices were a "small price to pay" for battlefield gains in Iran. He struck a different note Monday afternoon, telling a CBS reporter in an interview that the U.S. has attained most of its goals and that the conflict would end quickly.

Leaders of the Group of Seven advanced economies met Monday and decided not to tap their emergency oil reserves but signaled they may soon release that crude into the marketplace, a message that may also have helped calm markets.

SEE IRAN ON A16

**Iranian school:** Video appears to show U.S. missile hit in area. **A8**

**Embassies clearing:** U.S. steps up the evacuation of diplomats. **A9**

**Cap flap:** Trump is criticized for his transfer ceremony headwear. **A10**

ALEXANDER BUTTERFIELD 1926-2026

## Former Nixon aide revealed White House tapes

His testimony about secret recordings jolted Watergate investigation

BY EMILY LANGER

"I was hoping you fellows wouldn't ask me about that," said Alexander P. Butterfield, a former White House aide summoned before the staff of the Senate Watergate committee on July 13, 1973.

His questioner had alighted on a matter that would electrify the investigation of corruption and cover-up in President Richard M. Nixon's administration. It involved a wiretapping — not the attempt by Nixon campaign operatives to eavesdrop on the Democratic national headquarters at the Watergate building in 1972, but the president's secret bugging of his own office conversations.

Mr. Butterfield, then chief of the Federal Aviation Administration and previously the White House deputy chief of staff, insisted on his loyalty to the president but did not want to lie. On Nixon's

SEE BUTTERFIELD ON A4



AP

**Alexander Butterfield appeared before the Senate committee investigating Watergate in 1973.**

## The legal tool that leads to immigrant detentions

Arrests in Minneapolis surge as ICE officials use reinterpretation of a 1996 law to defy court orders

BY MARIA SACCHETTI  
AND N. KIRKPATRICK

MINNEAPOLIS — Jose Avendano tried explaining to the immigration officer yanking him out of his car that he had permission to be in the United States. The 62-year-old dishwasher had fled El Salvador decades ago and had a valid work permit and one of the few temporary statuses offering protection from deportation that the Trump administration wasn't revoking.

"They didn't listen," Avendano said.

As he was being shuttled to a detention camp near a U.S. military base in El Paso in early January, most of Minneapolis and the nation was focused on the clashes between protesters and federal immigration officers that led to the fatal shootings of two U.S. citizens and ignited tensions over the Trump administration's mass-deportation campaign.

More than 4,000 people have been arrested in Minneapolis since the start of Operation Metro Surge in December, and federal judges and civil rights lawyers say many of those detentions broke the law. The Washington Post reviewed nearly 70 cases in which U.S. District Judge Patrick J. Schiltz ruled that the Trump administration had violated court orders. The court records offer the most detailed account yet on who officers arrested in Minneapolis and how they conducted arrests.

The case files show how officers repeatedly detained people under a reinterpretation of a 1996 law that states that anyone in the United States illegally "shall be detained" without bond, indefinitely, even when courts had ordered they be granted a bond hearing or set free. Most were quickly transferred to detention centers in Texas or Louisiana.

SEE ARRESTS ON A2

### IN THE NEWS

**Detention business** The Trump administration picked untested firms to oversee centers in Maryland and Arizona. **A3**

**Ex-officer accused:** A former D.C. police officer faces dozens of charges of sexually assaulted women he met on dating apps in multiple cases across the region. **B13**

#### THE NATION

**The FBI** obtained voting data from Arizona GOP's 2020 review confirming Trump's loss. **A4**  
**Two men charged** with throwing bombs at protest in New York cited ISIS, officials say. **A6**

#### THE WORLD

The letter written by Mary, Queen of Scots, before her beheading in 1587 has drawn large crowds since it went on display at Perth Museum near Edinburgh, Scotland. **A13**

#### THE ECONOMY

**AI company** Anthropic files a federal lawsuit against the Pentagon over being labeled a national security risk. **A15**  
**Live Nation** and Ticketmaster have agreed to settle an antitrust lawsuit with the Justice Department, pending approval from a judge. **A15**

#### STYLE

**IndyCar drivers** will soon rocket past famous D.C. landmarks at expected top speeds of 185 mph during the Freedom 250 Grand Prix. **B1**

#### SPORTS

**The Commanders** open free agency by spending big on their needs in the trenches. **B7**

#### THE REGION

**Jeremiah Woods**, a Black 21-year-old who transferred out of the VMI this year, is lobbying to cut the state-supported military college's Confederate ties. **B13**  
**An autistic man** in Maryland called police for a wellness check. He was fatally shot. **B13**

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